and half a dozen armed helicopters manned by Soviet pilots remained airborne, making low passes over Kabul. Arms were issued to party workers. The government accused British, American, Pakistani and Chinese spies of murder, looting and arson. Seventeen suspected agents—sixteen Pakistanis and one American—were arrested for causing law and order problems.

The unexpected success of the agitation was due to the traditional hostility of Afghans to the presence of any foreign troops in their country. There was also a general feeling that Babrak Karmal was no better than his predecessors Hafizullah Amin and Nur Taraki.

India was active in the grey world of Afghanistan, but overt activities were carefully crafted to suit strategic ties with all the countries overwhelmingly interested in Afghanistan. In February 1980, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi sent a message to Karmal through S.K. Singh, India's special envoy to Afghanistan. Indira believed that China's and the USA's arms support to Pakistan meant that they wanted to interfere in the affairs of Afghanistan in the same way as the USA had done during the now deposed Shah's regime in Iran. The R&AW helped Afghanistan's fledgling security apparatus launch a counteroffensive against ISI agents operating in the region. Behind the scenes, the R&AW network provided accurate inputs on arms smuggled from Pakistan to insurgents in Kandahar.

'Not a single raid was unsuccessful,' Reddy said about the operation that the Afghanistan army carried out based on R&AW information to KHAD. Between a thousand and twelve hundred armed Afghan insurgents infiltrated Kandahar and its neighbouring areas, Kars, Balakarz and Malajat, to train and arm locals against the Soviet army. On the basis of R&AW inputs, the